

Fount of Living
Water University
College of
Graduate Studies

Course Syllabus

Graduate Counseling Department

COUN801

Title: Group Counseling

Instructor: Future Dr. Raymond Wagoner

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Office Hours: by appointment via Teams

I. Description of the course

In this course, students will be introduced to group theory, practice in group theory, ethics, and professional issues in group counseling in an experiential setting. Through group counseling theory and practice from several theories, students experience the theories, with each other and the instructor, in a process group formed of the class participants.

II. Rationale:

Developing competency in counseling requires the knowledge and understanding of current practices in effective counseling theories. The skills of group counseling are utilized in many areas of the helping profession, such as school counseling, inpatient treatment, family counseling, and community counseling. Theories of group counseling are applicable to counseling practice as a whole and can be translated to dynamics of family, work, and all forms of interpersonal relationships. This course will allow students the opportunity to experience the dynamics of group process theory for themselves and continue developing the skills, theories, and practice necessary for a well-rounded professional career.

III. Texts:

Corey, M. S., Corey, G., Corey, C. (2017). *Groups: Process and practice* (10th ed). Cengage Learning. ISBN: 9781305865709

Rationale: This clearly and concisely written text is produced from years of clinical experience working with groups of all natures and constructions. The authors give practical guidance and tools for students to learn to work with multiple people in the counseling setting. The tenth edition gives up-to-date information on the ethical, legal, and practical implications of forming and leading groups. The attention to diversity, applicable exercises, and additional resources makes this text an

instructor-friendly tool for encouraging experiential learning. This text would be used as a supplemental resource with the Yalom text. This is because the Corey text is more of a universal application for groups of all settings and populations. The text below has a process group orientation that fits the nature of interpersonal relationships. However, this text is affordable and can become a part of the students' library for reference for years to come.

Yalom, I. D. & Leszcz, M. (2020) *The Theory and practice of group psychotherapy* (6th ed). Basic Books. ISBN: 9781541617575

Rationale: This text is based on years of research-driven group counseling practice. Dr. Yalom is considered one of the world's leading authorities on group counseling. The years of experience of both authors are evident in the vignettes and clinical examples given for every aspect of theory and practice. The thorough nature of the text allows an instructor to lean on the mistakes and successes of the authors when introducing students to the dynamics of interpersonal relationships. Students can gain academic and practical knowledge of the intricacies of group counseling through the study of this text. The time-tested process for forming, initiating, working, and culminating a group gives the instructor and student a clear overview of group counseling from beginning to end.

IV. Learning Outcomes:

This course is designed to meet CACREP standards for licensure and practice in the clinical and mental health profession. Upon completion of this course, students will be able to:

CACREP Standard	Performance Measure
Explain the theoretical frameworks of group counseling (F.6.a)	Theoretical Frameworks paper: Review the Corey and Yalom texts and write a 10-page paper discussing the theories addressed in each text/Quizzes
Explore the dynamics of group process and interpersonal group work (F.6.b)	Journal Experience/Quizzes
Characterize specific therapeutic factors related to group counseling and determine how they contribute to effective therapy (F.6.c)	Class discussion/Creation of Group paper/Quizzes
Defend characteristics and roles of effective group leaders (F.6.d)	Class discussion/Creation of Group paper/Quizzes
Examine theoretical models of group formation, assimilation, procedures, and termination (F.6.e)	Theoretical Frameworks paper/Creation of Group paper/Quizzes
Distinguish group population types and purpose types and how each type should be led (F.6.f)	Class discussion/Papers/Group Multicultural Competency presentation/Quizzes

Identify the ethical considerations specific to group counseling and how these considerations effect the formation and procedures of group counseling (F.6.g)	Creation of group paper/Theoretical Framework paper/Class discussion/Ethical dilemma worksheet/Quizzes
Construct an environment for members of the class to experience group counseling in person throughout the semester (F.6.h)	Creation of group paper: Review the Corey and Yalom texts and research peer reviewed articles to design a group for a specific population and purpose that could be used with a group in the future/Quizzes

V. Course Assignments

- a. **Reading Journal.** Each student is expected to complete a reading journal submitted in the Discussion section of the course in Canvas. Each journal entry should reflect assimilation of the material for the chapter assigned that week. (F.6.a-h)
- b. **Quizzes.** There will be ten quizzes throughout the semester covering the lectures. The quizzes will be accessible immediately after each class lecture. Students may use notes and will have two opportunities to submit the quiz. (F.6.a-h)
- c. **Class Participation.** Each student will receive a grade from the professor at the semester's end regarding his/her class participation. (F.6.a-h)
- d. **Theoretical Frameworks Paper.** Each student is required to submit a 10-page paper discussing the theories found in the two required texts. This paper should follow all APA-7 guidelines and be submitted as an original document through Canvas. (F.6.a)
- e. **Group Multicultural Competency Presentation.** Students will choose a group of four to research the specific considerations of multiculturalism relative to group counseling and present a 10-minute approach to broaching and maintaining awareness of these considerations from the group leader's perspective. Each group will choose from a list of considerations outlined by the professor. (F.6.f-h)
- f. **Experience Journal.** After each meeting, students will write 3-6 paragraphs about their individual experience in the process group setting. There will be ten class meetings in which students will have the opportunity to experience a process group led by the professor and a co-leader. The student will note how the dynamics of this group impacted and affected her accordingly. (See Appendix A for further explanation of this assignment) (F.6.a-h)
- g. **Creation of a Group Paper.** Students will write a 15-page paper delineating the creation of a future group based on the two required texts and peer-reviewed journal articles. (See Appendix B for further instructions on this assignment) (F.6.a-h)

VI. Course Grading

All assignments must be completed to pass the course.

Evaluation	Points
Reading journal	50
Quizzes over lectures 15 x 10 = 150	150
Class participation	100
Theoretical Frameworks paper	200
Group Multicultural Competency presentation	100
Experience Journal	200
Creation of Group Paper	200
Total	1000

Grading Criteria. [Remember, this is set by your department so use this example]:

A = 940-1000 A- = 920-939 B+ = 900-919 B = 860-899 B- = 840-859
C+ = 820-839 C = 780-819 C- = 760-779 D+ = 740-759 D = 700-739
D- = 680-699 F = Below 67

VII. Course Calendar

Course Calendar: Group Counseling Course

Week	Topics	Assignments
1	- Theoretical Frameworks of Group Counseling lecture	- Theoretical Frameworks paper: Corey Ch 1, Yalom Ch 1-5, 16
2	- Presence in Group Counseling and Here-And-Now understanding lecture	- Theoretical Frameworks paper and Creation of Group paper (Due week 15): Corey Ch 7, Yalom Ch 6-7
3	- Group experience/Class discussion	- Class discussion/Experience Journal (Due Week 14): Corey Ch 5,6, & 8, Yalom Ch 11-13
4	- Group presentations	- Group presentations: Corey Ch 3

Attendance Policy

As this course utilizes the experience of a group dynamic for a significant portion of the grading and learning outcomes, attendance on all class dates is required. The exceptions to this policy will be for the death of an immediate family member, an illness that would be contagious to the group, or a personal family emergency that would not exceed two class meetings. Please email the professor prior to class to inform him of your absence as soon as possible. Additional entries in your journal assignment may be required for these absences.

Other Policies

- a. Honesty in scholasticism.
All assignments are expected to be original to the student submitting the assignment. Plagiarism is not tolerated by Fount of Living Water University or the College of Graduate Studies. Each assignment will be automatically checked by Turnitin when electronically submitted to Canvas. Please see the student handbook for further policy explanations.
- b. Please read and refer to the Fount of Living Water College of Graduate Studies handbook for policies relating to professionalism, academic standards, grading, accessibility, and students with disabilities.

Appendix A

Experience Journal Assignment Instructions

An experience journal is designed to help the student digest and assimilate her experience in a process group counseling setting. The journal will be a confidential and private communication between the professor and the student. The student is free to reflect on, externalize, and/or critically interact with any part or person in the group (including the professor and co-leader). No points will be deducted for critically interacting with the individuals in the group. However, fewer points may be given in the professionalism category for inappropriate comments about or directed toward individuals in the group (See the rubric below). Journal entries will be created after each of the ten process group "sessions." Dated entries should reflect the content and interactions of the "session" the entry is created to reflect upon. The following areas will be assessed for grading purposes:

Summary: students should commit 1-3 paragraphs (1/3 of each entry) to summarize the meta-processing and interpersonal dynamics of the "session." This summary should not be in quoting other members. Rather, it should summarize the interactions as they relate to the student's individual relationships in the group.

Reflection: students should commit 1-3 paragraphs (1/3 of each entry) to the contemplation of how the group may be changing them personally. What aspects of process group theory are in play with the call to change? What aspects of interpersonal dynamics are in play with that call to change? What aspects of the here-and-now setting is the student appreciative of? What aspects of process groups and here-and-now settings is the student not appreciative of?

Critical interaction: students should commit 1-3 paragraphs (1/3 of each entry) to personal reflections on how a process group creates change. This should be a discussion of theory based on reading, lecture, and class discussion. Students should fully engage with the current models and ideas of how group counseling differs from individual counseling and applies to certain situations and populations.

The journal will be written and submitted in a physical paper format. A spiral notebook, a "moleskin" journal, or a composition notebook are all examples that will be accepted. The journal will be submitted twice in the semester, once after the fifth process group "session" and once after the tenth process group "session." One final grade will be given for the assignment after the second submission on week 14 of the course. There are 200 points possible for the assignment.

Grading Rubric

Criteria	Ratings				Points
Summary 50 points	Advanced: meta-processing and interpersonal dynamics are present. A clear summary of interactions is given. 47-50	Proficient Some quotes from group members are used. Interpersonal summaries are not related to the student personally. 42-47	Developing Entries do not show an understanding of interpersonal dynamics or meta-processing. 0-42	Not Present 0 points	
Reflection 50 Points	Advanced: Questions of how aspects of process group theory are personally affecting the student are clearly related. Aspects of the here-and-now activation are used to relate the personal change of the student. 47-50	Proficient: The student reflects on change but does not clearly articulate the here-and-now activation. The student does not adequately consider aspects of process group theory in reflections on change. 42-47	Developing: Entries do not show an understanding of process group theory or the here-and-now activation of group process. 0-42	Not Present 0 points	
Critical Interaction 50 Points	Advanced: Entries clearly and professionally engage the current models of group theory in the texts, lectures on group theory, and class discussions on group theory. Entries critically engage the theories in relation to the experience of the process group. 47-50	Proficient: The student critically engages the current models but does not engage the textbooks, lectures, or class discussions. The criticism does not relate to the experience in the group. 42-47	Developing: Entries do not critically engage the current models at a level that shows an understanding of the material. 0-42	Not Present 0 points	
Structure 50 Points	Advanced: The journal is submitted in a format described in the instructions. The journal is dated, outlined, and divided into sections according to the instructions. The journal is written legibly enough for the professor to read and grade the entries. 47-50	Proficient: The journal meets the requirements of the three sections but is not clear on some aspects of the instructions to allow the professor to clearly identify which "session" is being processed. The journal is not always legible enough for grading purposes. 42-47	Developing: Structure, dates, or sections of the journal or entries are missing. 0-42	Not Present 0 points	
					200

Appendix B

Creation of Group Paper Instructions

Purpose: the creation of a group paper is a synthesis of the course. As the course progresses, students will become aware of how group counseling is effective and when it is preferred to individual counseling. Future counselors need to analyze and understand many aspects of group counseling. The “creating a group” paper will allow students to propose a group in a style they would like to consider in the future. Each student will read a minimum of 5 peer-reviewed journal articles from the last ten years and write a paper based on the proposal.

Instructions:

Papers should be written in APA-7 format and adhere to the guidelines therein. Each paper should have a title page, abstract, section headings, and a reference page. Papers should be 12-15 pages in length, not including the title page, abstract, and references. Papers should be written with the section headings of 1. Introduction, 2. Literature review, 3. Group type, 4. Theory, 5. Group stages, 6. Ethics and Multi-cultural Considerations, 7. Conclusion.

Grading Rubric

Criteria	Rating				Points
Literature Review 70 points	Advanced: 5 articles are reviewed and cited throughout the paper. A clear synthesis of the current literature referring to the four sections of the proposed group is present. The articles are relevant, recent, and applicable to the proposal. 66-70	Proficient: only 4 articles are referenced and cited. Some aspects of the other four sections are missing in the review. 59-66	Developing: 3 or fewer articles are referenced and cited. Articles do not address the stated proposal in a manner evident to the reader. Articles are outdated or from non-peer-reviewed journals. 0-59	Not present 0	
Group Type 20 points	Advanced: Clear proposal of the type of group for the population and presenting problems is present. 18-20	Proficient: Some aspect of the group population and presenting problem is not identified or considered. 16-18	Developing: The group type does not fit the population or presenting problem. 0-18	Not present 0	
Theory 20 points	Advanced: Theory is clearly stated and conceptualized for the proposed group type. 18-20	Proficient: Some aspect of the theory is not clearly identified or considered. 16-18	Developing: The theory chosen does not fit the group type. 0-18	Not present 0	
Stages 20 points	Advanced: All stages of the group are identified and considered in	Proficient: One or more stages of group counseling is missing or not	Developing: The stages identified do not coincide	Not present 0	

	relation to the proposed group. 18-20	clearly considered.16-18	with the proposal. 0-18		
Ethics/Multi-Cultural 20 points	Advanced: 3-5 ethical dilemmas and 1 issue of multi-cultural competency is raised and addressed as it related to the proposed group. 18-20	Proficient: Ethical dilemma and multi-cultural competencies in group counseling are raised and addressed but not related to the proposed group. 16-18	Developing: Ethical dilemmas and multi-cultural competencies are not specifically relevant to group counseling. 0-18	Not present 0	
Structure/APA 50 points	Advanced: paper is 15 pages in length. Paper is free of grammatical and spelling errors. Paper follows APA formatting with regards to headings, spacing, title page, abstract, and reference pages. 47-50	Proficient: Paper is 12-14 pages in length. Paper has minor grammatical and spelling errors. Paper has minor errors regarding APA formatting. 42-47	Developing: Paper is 12 or fewer pages in length. Paper has major grammatical or spelling errors. Paper has major errors regarding APA formatting. 0-42	Not present 0	
					200